SUCRALFATE

Empty stomach
Separate from other drugs

CHEMICAL NAME Basic aluminium salt of sucrose octasulfate
CLASS Mucosal protectant (cytoprotective agent)
TRADE NAMES Carafate · Antepsin · Ulcermin

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Duodenal and gastric ulcer (treatment, maintenance).
- Stress-ulcer prophylaxis (ICU).
- Chronic gastritis; oral mucositis (suspension mouthwash).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- In acid forms a sticky paste that binds to ulcer base (protein) → barrier against acid, pepsin, bile.
- Stimulates prostaglandins and bicarbonate; does not significantly neutralise acid.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** 1 h before meals and at bedtime on an empty stomach.
- Tablets may be dispersed in water; suspension available.
- Separate other drugs by 2 h; avoid via NG tube with enteral feeds (bezoar).

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Constipation.
- Dry mouth, nausea.
- Back pain, dizziness.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Aluminium accumulation in renal failure.
- Bezoar formation (ICU, enteral feeding).
- Hyperglycaemia in diabetics (suspension).

DOSAGES

- **Ulcer:** 1 g four times daily for 4–8 weeks.
- **Maintenance:** 1 g twice daily.
- **Stress-ulcer prophylaxis:** 1 g every 6 h.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** chronic renal failure/dialysis, dysphagia, enteral feeding.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- ↓ absorption of ciprofloxacin, levofloxacin, digoxin, phenytoin, levothyroxine, warfarin, ketoconazole, tetracyclines.
- **Antacids:** separate by 30 min.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- Minimal absorption (<5%); small amount of Al absorbed.
- Acts locally for ~6 h.
- Excreted in faeces.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Schedule 1 h before meals; keep other drugs 2 h apart.
- Monitor bowel function.
- Monitor Al levels in renal failure.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take on an empty stomach 1 h before meals and at bedtime.
- Keep other medicines 2 h apart.
- Increase fluids and fibre for constipation.

KEY POINTS

- Coats ulcer base — mucosal barrier.
- Constipation; aluminium in renal failure.
- 1 g QDS before meals.
- Binds many drugs.

SOURCES CHECKED **[522]** Sucralfate, oral (US label) **[523]** Sucralfate, oral (US label, Preferred Pharmaceuticals Inc)
Full references p. 432–457